MARITIME POWER RESEARCH · CYBERDEFENSE · STRATEGIC STUDIES

Cyber power as a structural variable of maritime power

A normalized multiplicative model for multidomain assessment of maritime power

Cabuya-Padilla, Uribe-Cáceres & Castaneda-Marroquin · Manuscript under review, IEEE Access

$$MP_{norm} = [(\ MI \times NP\ ) \times SW \times MS^{\gamma} \times CP^{\alpha}\ ]^{1/n_{eff}}$$

$n_{eff} = 3 + \gamma + \alpha$ · $MP_{norm} \in (0, 1]$ · weighted geometric mean · keeps the classical core MP = MI × NP

FROM THE CLASSICAL TO THE EXTENDED FORMULA

The classical formula: sound, but incomplete. MP = MI × NP (Solís Oyarzún, 1997; Uribe Cáceres et al., 2016) does not include cyberspace, strategic will or the security of the environment as structural variables.

The proposal: update it, not replace it. Three structural variables and a normalization that makes the result interpretable. Existing measures are additive; in this one, the collapse of a component cannot be offset.

THE FIVE VARIABLES – TWO LEVELS

MI
Maritime interests

$MI = \Sigma\ w_i \cdot MI_i$

Weighted sub-index. Colombia: 18 interests (CCO, 2021).

NP
Naval power

$NP = (F \times P \times MDA^{\mu})^{1/(2+\mu)}$

Force, position and domain awareness.

SW
Strategic will

$(PW \cdot IW \cdot SocW)^{1/\Sigma w}$

Multiplier of the system: political, institutional and social.

MS
Maritime security

$(IC \cdot TE \cdot BC)^{1/\Sigma a}$

Incidence of threats: conflicts, terrorism, blue crime.

CP
Cyber power

$\min\{1, (\beta_1 CS_m + \beta_2 CD_m + \beta_3 RC_m)(1+\delta \cdot CDip)\}$

Cybersecurity, strategic cyberdefense, recovery + cyber diplomacy.

INTERPRETATION SCALE – COLOMBIAN SCENARIO

Critical	Low	Moderate	Significant	High
(0, 0.20]	(0.20, 0.40]	(0.40, 0.60]	(0.60, 0.80]	(0.80, 1]

▲ **Colombia: MP_{norm} = 0.455** – Moderate level, hypothetical scenario. Only MS comes from an external source (rank 75 of 99, Vargas-Suárez et al., 2021 → 0.24); the other values are assumed.

ROBUSTNESS

With inputs ± 0.10, Moderate in 96.6% of the draws; with ± 0.20, in 78.1% (Low, 21.0%). In this scenario, MS and γ dominate the variance.

Where to invest? Sensitivity is not enough: costs are needed

Proposition 1. $MP_{norm} = G^{1-w} \cdot CP^{w}$, $w = \alpha/n_{eff}$: raising CP always raises the index; raising α only if CP > G. α is a weight, not a capability.

Marginal return (Colombian scenario). MS 0.312 · SW 0.223 · NP 0.195 · MI 0.178 · CP 0.147.

Corollary 1. Cyber power would be the most efficient vector only if raising the others cost at least 1.21× (MI), 1.32× (NP), 1.52× (SW), 2.12× (MS).

Theoretical framework. Maritime power joins naval power and maritime interests; cyber power cuts across both, and its reach, unlike naval power's, does not decay with distance, though its effect depends on access (Nye, 2010; Booth, 1977; NATO, 2025).

Ocean policy. The national ocean policy (PNOEC), which frames the development plans, already treats political will as a variable of its Medium Oceanic Power goal, but does not mention cyberspace or cybersecurity (CCO, 2018).

FIVE CONTRIBUTIONS

1 · Structural CP
With explicit operational boundaries.

2 · System-wide SW
Multiplier of all of MP.

3 · Disaggregated MS
Incidence of threats, weight γ.

4 · Normalization
Five-level scale; verification.

5 · MDA ≠ consciousness
Technical versus cultural.

Agenda: National Maritime Power Index with a calibration and external-validation protocol · regional extension · dynamic modeling · **Simulator:** diegocabuya.github.io/Cyber_Power_and_Maritime_Power/simulator/simulator.html